

The 6:15

FRIDAY · AUGUST 28, 2026

NO. 8

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS)

Fri 8/28	Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote, 10:00a ET — time now confirmed (last issue had it pending).
Mon 9/1	Labor Day (markets closed); 4-week T-bill auction settles.
Fri 9/4	August jobs report (nonfarm payrolls), 8:30a (BLS).
Tue 9/8	Canada's retaliatory "dollar-for-dollar" tariffs on U.S. steel, dairy, appliances, ag equipment, pulp/paper, electronics take effect.
Fri 9/11	August CPI, 8:30a (BLS). [NEW: date confirmed]
Tue 9/16	Next FOMC decision.

[DEVELOPING] Anthropic's public S-1 still hadn't appeared as of press time despite reports it could arrive "as soon as" late August; still targeting an October Nasdaq listing at a reported ~\$2T valuation vs. its \$965B May Series H. **[flag: not yet filed; valuation reported, not confirmed]** [NEW] USS Theodore Roosevelt strike group departs San Diego in coming weeks for a 7-plus-month Middle East deployment (see Iran & Hormuz) — a scheduling item, not a calendar-category one, but the clearest forward-dated signal this run. No verified political-primary, rocket-launch, frontier-model or VC-round item fell inside this window.

METRICS · TIMES ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	No clean settle. Brent indicative \$88.13 (Investing.com, 6:14a, -0.44%) vs. \$89.77 (straits.live, 1017Z, +1.66%) vs. \$88.22 (Trading Economics, -0.34%) — sources split on direction. WTI similarly split: \$83.00 (+1.06%) vs. \$81.36 (-1.06%); no fresh NYMEX settle located. [flag: divergent, no clean settle either grade]
2y/10y/30y	4.24% / 4.67% / 5.20% (Thu 8/27 close)
DXY	99.12, little changed
S&P / Nasdaq fut.	~flat / -0.3% (Marvell/Rubrik drag); Dow fut. +0.2% (Fri premarket)
VIX	14.51 (Thu close, -4.6%)

Gold	~\$4,590-4,595/oz, little changed after Wed's steepest one-day drop in a week, still near 3-month highs
S&P / Dow / Nasdaq	7,730.99 (+0.72%) / 53,569.44 (+0.2%, 4th straight gain) / 26,541.35 (+1.57%) — Thu close
Asia / Europe	Nikkei 66,405 (Fri close, +0.41%); Hang Seng 25,585 (Fri close, +0.1%); STOXX 600 651.85 (Thu close, -0.69%) [DAX not cleanly dated this run]
Retail gas	\$4.0898/gal natl. avg (AAA, 8/28), down from \$4.0997 on 8/27

Rates: Treasury.gov/CME. Equities/futures: exchange and wire quotes as cited. Oil: ICE Brent / NYMEX WTI front-month.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 180 (straits.live, as of 8/28 1017Z)
Transits	PortWatch: 3 vessels 8/23 vs. 85/day pre-crisis baseline (~4% of normal). Kpler: still 2 tankers 8/24 vs. 10-day avg. 14, no fresher print. Lloyd's List: nothing fresher than last issue. [flag: still stale]
Strikes	Second unattributed strike this week — UKMTO Warning 121-26 (incident 8/25 1730Z, published 8/27): unnamed tanker off Khasab, Oman, hit by unknown projectile, fire extinguished, crew safe. [NEW] Comes 4 days after the still-unattributed Metro Venetian strike. Running total: straits.live still indexes 55+ crisiswide; no update located.
War-risk premium	VLCC ~\$10.0M/transit, ~40x pre-crisis (straits.live) [same stale quote as last issue]
Dark tankers	38 of 219 screened show AIS gaps vs. 7-day baseline 53.1 (straits.live) [screened pool widened from 156 — not a clean diff vs. last issue]

Kpler's near-real-time AIS daily counts, Lloyd's List's slower weekly commercial-transit aggregation, and PortWatch's baseline-comparison snapshots measure different things over different windows — don't net or average them against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Lost to Houston 5-1 Thu 8/27. 74-58, 2nd AL East, holds AL's No. 1 Wild Card. [GB Tampa Bay not cleanly confirmed this run]
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Knicks

Hart extension talks still centered on 3-yr/\$60-62M — unsigned. **[DEVELOPING, unchanged]**

Northwestern

Named 6 captains for 2026 (Brus, Carsello, Chiles, Fitzgerald, Himon II, Wilde). **[NEW]**

LEAD

THE AI TRADE STARTS DISCRIMINATING

Marvell's beat-and-raise gets sold anyway — margin mix, not growth, is now what moves these stocks

Marvell Technology reported fiscal second-quarter revenue of \$2.739 billion Thursday after the close, a record, up 37% year-over-year and above the roughly \$2.71-2.72 billion consensus. Non-GAAP EPS of \$0.94 topped the \$0.93 estimate; GAAP EPS was \$0.33 on GAAP gross margin of 53.1% (58.9% non-GAAP). Data Center revenue reached \$2.171 billion, up 46% year-over-year and now 79% of total sales, up 18% sequentially. The company guided third-quarter revenue to \$3.15 billion, plus or minus 5% — above the roughly \$3 billion figure CEO Matt Murphy had flagged a full quarter early — with non-GAAP EPS of \$1.10, plus or minus a nickel. **[NEW]**

None of that stopped the stock from falling as much as 8.4% in after-hours and premarket trading, dragging Nasdaq 100 futures down roughly 0.3% into Friday's open even as S&P and Dow futures held closer to flat. The mechanism: alongside the beat, Marvell guided third-quarter non-GAAP gross margin to 57.5-58.5%, below the 58.9% just reported. CFO Dan Durn told analysts the sequential dip is being driven by custom-ASIC programs — chips built to hyperscaler specification for AI accelerators — ramping faster than the company's off-the-shelf optical and switching lines, which carry

fatter margins. [fact] Rubrik, the backup-and-recovery software company, fell a similar 9% overnight on its own beat-and-raise: EPS of \$0.22 against a four-cent estimate, revenue of \$427.3 million against \$396.3 million consensus, both blown past, followed by an almost identical sell-off. [read: two beat-and-raises punished the same night, on the same mechanism — expensive growth stocks that had run hard into the print (Marvell +187% year-to-date, Rubrik +85% over six months) getting sold on any imperfection in the mix rather than the headline number, is a different market behavior than two days earlier, when Nvidia's own beat-and-raise was rewarded outright.]

That contrast with Wednesday matters more than either print alone. Nvidia's Q3 guide beat consensus by nearly \$4 billion and traded up 6% because nothing in the print complicated the growth story; Marvell's guide beat by a comparable margin and traded down because the mix did. [read: the AI-capex trade is no longer being priced as one undifferentiated basket — investors are starting to discriminate between hardware makers whose growth comes with margin dilution (Marvell's custom-silicon ramp, priced at hyperscaler-negotiated rates) and those whose growth doesn't (Nvidia's merchant-GPU pricing power). That's a more selective phase of the trade than the "any AI beat gets bought" pattern that held through most of August, and it complicates the setup for whichever comes next.] Marvell's customer book is also more concentrated than Nvidia's: its custom-ASIC and optical-interconnect revenue leans on a small set of hyperscalers, chiefly Google and Amazon, and Thursday's sell-side commentary specifically cited uncertainty over the timing of incremental Google-

related revenue as a factor in the reaction. [read: concentration risk Nvidia's broader hyperscaler base doesn't carry as acutely.]

The result lands the futures tape in a more unsettled place than Wednesday's Nvidia-driven exuberance suggested three days ago — Nasdaq 100 futures red, S&P and Dow closer to flat — just as Fed Chair Kevin Warsh prepares to deliver his first Jackson Hole keynote as chair at 10:00 a.m. ET. [fact] A CNBC survey found 45% of respondents don't expect Warsh to expand on the rate outlook at all, and Fed officials remain publicly divided between a resilient growth tape and inflation still running above target. [read: Warsh now speaks into a market already discriminating within its highest-conviction trade rather than uniformly euphoric — a tougher room to move with a "blank piece of paper," his own description of the speech, than the one he'd have faced Wednesday afternoon.]

POLITICS

Lisa Cook's attorney Abbe David Lowell sent a letter Wednesday to White House counsel David Warrington rejecting the administration's renewed "for cause" removal push, which the White House is basing on an FHFA criminal referral alleging Cook misrepresented multiple mortgages as "primary residences" and failed to disclose rental income from an Atlanta condo — the specific legal basis wasn't detailed in prior coverage. [DEVELOPING: basis specified] Lowell's letter: "Governor Cook has never committed mortgage fraud or any intentional wrongdoing, and there is no legally cognizable cause for removing her from the Federal Reserve Board." No White House response as of press time. [fact] The dispute follows the Supreme Court's June 5-4 ruling blocking Trump from removing Fed governors at will absent cause

— a threshold the White House is now trying to clear formally on the FHFA referral rather than test again on an emergency docket. [read] The timing is awkward for the administration on its own terms: a fresh Fed-independence fight lands the same morning as Warsh's inaugural Jackson Hole address, and any renewed removal attempt would put a second contested governor-count question in front of markets just as the new chair is trying to establish credibility on rate policy independent of the White House that appointed him. [read] A successful removal before the Sept. 16 FOMC decision would be unprecedented in the Fed's modern history — no sitting governor has previously been excluded from a rate vote by White House action rather than resignation or term expiration — which is the underlying reason the Supreme Court treated the June case as consequential enough to take up on the merits rather than resolve on the emergency docket alone. [read] The House-Senate funding gap remains unresolved and unchanged since last issue; omitted here per the no-repetition rule.

ECONOMICS

Thursday's initial jobless claims fell to 203,000 for the week ended Aug. 22, down 4,000 from a revised 207,000 and below the 208,000 consensus, with the four-week moving average at 205,500 (up 1,250 on the week) — a labor market still showing no cracks heading into next Friday's August jobs report and the Sept. 11 CPI print (see Board). [NEW: actual reading] Attention now sits almost entirely on Warsh's 10:00 a.m. Jackson Hole keynote, his first as chair; Fed officials remain publicly split between the resilient growth tape and inflation still running above target, and a CNBC survey found 45% of respondents don't expect him to add color on the rate path at all (see Lead). [fact] Warsh has called the speech "a blank piece of

paper." Roughly 120 attendees from more than 70 countries are at the symposium under the theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy" — unchanged since last issue. [read: the Fed-chair Jackson Hole keynote has been a policy-signal venue since Bernanke's 2010 QE2 preview; markets are treating today's slot the same way by default, even though Warsh himself has pushed back on that framing, which is itself the source of the CNBC survey's split expectations.] The Treasury's 4-week bill auction settles Monday (Labor Day, markets closed) — the next test of demand at the short end following Bessent's expanded long-bond buyback program (covered last issue; unchanged this run).

BUSINESS

Beyond the margin story in the Lead: Marvell's stock had run up roughly 187% year-to-date into Thursday's print, and Rubrik's had risen about 85% over six months to an intraday record \$107.91 ahead of its own report — both reactions read as much as profit-taking into extended valuations as commentary on the results themselves. [read] SentinelOne posted the same pattern from a different angle: Q2 adjusted EPS of \$0.08 beat the \$0.07 estimate, revenue rose 21% year-over-year to \$292 million (vs. \$290.2 million consensus), operating margin hit a record 10%, and the company raised its full-year revenue and operating-income outlook — yet cut full-year adjusted-EPS guidance to roughly \$0.31 at the midpoint, an 11.4% reduction, sending shares lower Thursday. [NEW] Three richly-valued software/security names (Marvell, Rubrik, SentinelOne) were marked down in the same session for three distinct versions of the same complaint: near-term profitability guidance falling short of an otherwise strong top-line print. [read] IREN, the AI-datacenter and crypto-infrastructure operator, cut the

other way: fiscal Q4 revenue of \$137.2 million missed the \$142.3 million estimate and fell from \$187.3 million a year earlier, but management said \$4 billion of 2026 capacity is already contracted, with most of that capacity sold out and \$1 billion already operating — a backlog story overriding a revenue miss. [NEW] No fresh development located this run on Intuit or Dick's Sporting Goods, both reported as actuals last issue.

TECHNOLOGY

Anthropic's public S-1 still hadn't appeared as of press time despite reports it could arrive "as soon as" late August; the company is still said to be targeting an October Nasdaq listing at a valuation reported near \$2 trillion against its \$965 billion May Series H round — both figures unconfirmed by a primary filing (see Board). [DEVELOPING, unchanged] Marvell's custom-ASIC concentration in Google and Amazon (see Lead) is itself a technology-strategy data point: hyperscalers continue pushing merchant-silicon spend toward chips built to their own specifications, a shift that pressures vendor margins even as it grows their revenue — the same dynamic Broadcom has flagged in its own custom-silicon segment, and the next data point to watch when Broadcom reports (date not confirmed this run). [read] IREN's contracted-capacity backlog (see Business) points the same direction from the demand side: AI-infrastructure buyers are locking in multi-year capacity commitments even where quarterly revenue is volatile, a pattern that keeps capex guidance from the hyperscalers themselves as the more informative signal than any single vendor's quarterly print. [read] Several aggregator trackers flagged AI-model releases this week (a DeepSeek vision variant, a Z.AI update, an OpenAI voice-model claim), but none were corroborated by a primary-source announcement within this

run's search window, so none are logged here. [flag: aggregator-only, not verified] No verified rocket launch surfaced this run.

GEOPOLITICS

Russia launched a "massive" overnight barrage into Thursday across nine Ukrainian cities — 258 attack drones plus Oniks anti-ship and Iskander-M/KN-23 ballistic missiles, of which Ukraine's air force said it downed or suppressed 233 — a sharp escalation from last issue's 162-drone count two days earlier. [NEW] Falling debris and fires injured four in Kyiv; a daytime strike hit a Kharkiv shopping center and a residential building; the barrage killed one person in Zaporizhzhia and one in Kharkiv region, with at least 14 more wounded elsewhere. [fact] Ukraine's own campaign continued in parallel: a drone strike hit the Ryazan refinery (17M tonnes/year capacity, producing petrol, diesel and aviation fuel) — one of the main fuel arteries into Moscow — Thursday, part of a run of more than a dozen Ukrainian strikes on Russian oil infrastructure since Aug. 2, concentrated in Ryazan and Volgograd oblasts. [DEVELOPING] Zelenskyy, on the broader campaign: "Russia must feel that every day of this war will only come at a higher cost for it." [fact] Xi's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar; nothing new surfaced this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Qatar's Prime Minister Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani met Iranian FM Araghchi in Tehran Thursday — the first high-level Qatari visit to Tehran since the war began Feb. 28 — to discuss reviving U.S.-Iran dialogue and a proposed phased Hormuz plan under negotiation with Oman: a temporary shipping corridor, a joint mine-clearance project, and a proposed joint coordination center to manage maritime traffic and collect vessel information —

components not previously detailed in this brief. [DEVELOPING] The open question, per regional coverage, is whether the IRGC accepts reduced operational control under any such arrangement. [read] No agreement was announced. The visit came as UKMTO published (8/27, incident logged 8/25) a second unattributed strike this week — an unnamed tanker off Khasab, Oman, hit by an unknown projectile, fire extinguished, crew safe — four days after the still-unattributed Metro Venetian strike (see Board). [NEW] Separately, the U.S. Navy confirmed the USS Theodore Roosevelt strike group will depart San Diego in the coming weeks for a 7-plus-month Middle East rotation, relieving the George Washington in the Arabian Sea by mid-to-late September — a long-horizon commitment that reads against any near-term reopening. [read] Treasury's "economic D-Day" sanctions campaign (announced Monday, covered last issue) continues; Bessent has framed it as giving trading partners time to comply before harsher measures hit, targeting shipping, oil, crypto, gold and aviation networks routed through the UAE, Hong Kong, China, Singapore and Switzerland — scope detail not previously logged. [fact] Tehran has said it will respond "in a seismic manner," with no specifics provided yet. [DEVELOPING] Kpler's still-stale 2-tanker Aug. 24 count (see Board) remains the clearest evidence this run that flows, not just sentiment, have degraded.

SPORTS

Yankees	Lost to Houston 5-1 Thu 8/27 (5 hits, 2 errors). 74-58, 2nd AL East, holds AL's No. 1 Wild Card.
Knicks	Off-season, no game. Hart extension (3-yr/\$60-62M) still unsigned.

Northwestern

Off-season, no game. Named 6 captains for 2026; opens Sat 9/5 vs. South Dakota State.

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since 8/27: House-Senate funding gap, Bessent bond-buyback/Treasury-yield mechanics, Intuit/Dick's earnings recaps (already reported as actuals), Xi-Washington summit status, Araghchi's standard rhetorical framing. For next issue: report Warsh's actual Jackson Hole remarks and the market reaction, not the preview logged here; watch for attribution on both the Metro Venetian and the new Khasab-area strike; watch Amara's status (still unconfirmed past Aug. 21); watch for Anthropic's S-1 to actually go public; watch for a fresher Kpler/PortWatch/Lloyd's List Hormuz transit count, all still stale; watch Canada's Sept. 8 tariff date approaching; watch Broadcom's next earnings date as the next AI-capex data point; confirm the AL East games-behind figure (sources diverged 3.5-4.5 GB this run).

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.